

Le Tombeau de Saint-Saens

for

**Piano Four-Hands
and Narrator**

with Poetry by Ogden Nash

and Music by Christopher Kies

(and introductory and concluding remarks by the composer)

2002/2013/2020

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Le Tombeau de Saint-Saens

Introductory Remarks by the Composer

Narrator:

Christopher Kies was beset with sighs
When telemarketers called and asked for Mr. “Kize”.
To alleviate his frustration, he became a Klepto,
To augment this treatment, he took Bismol Pepto.
He stole from the rich, the poor, and any he could find
From among his close encounters with the classical, pop, and jazz kind.

The result was always more music, you see,
Because he really “did not know much ‘bout Geography.”
At first, *In rode Doug’s son* and best friend, *Marsha*,
So as to say, “piece, now we can startcha.”
And we’ll now end this beginning by simply saying,
“Hats off to Ogden Nash and Camille Saint-Saens
.....and musicians, START PLAYING!”

attacca Initial March

for Lisa Raposa Millar and Gregory Millar

*Composed in the A.D., in memory of B.C., and with special thanks to C.A.D.,
the F.D.A., C.F.C.'s, the F.H.A., D.E.S., the F.C.C., the F.A.A., all those who are A.D.D.,
the A.D.A., C.B.S., the S.G., the G.S.A., and, of course, the S.B.A.*

1. The Initial March

Original Key: B flat
(which is important to know.
Otherwise, the acronyms over the
title make no sense at all!)

music by Christopher Kies
arr. Piano Four-Hands 4/20
Poetry by Ogden Nash

The musical score is for a piece titled "1. The Initial March" in 2/4 time, with a tempo of 126 beats per minute. It is written for piano four-hands, with staves labeled "Primo" (top) and "Secondo" (bottom). The key signature is B-flat major. The score is divided into three systems, each starting with a measure number in a box (7, 7, and 13 respectively). Dynamics include *f* (forte), *mf* (mezzo-forte), and *mp* (mezzo-piano). The Primo part features a wavy line in the second measure of the first system. The Secondo part has a more active melody in the first system. The third system shows a change in dynamics and melodic focus between the two hands.

in appreciation of Kenneth Grahame

3. The Duck

Narrator: Behold the duck It does not cluck.
A cluck it lacks. It quacks.
It is specially fond Of a puddle or pond.
When it dines or sups, It bottoms ups.

The musical score is written for two piano parts, Primo and Secondo, in 3/4 time. The tempo is marked as 132 beats per minute. The key signature has one flat (B-flat). The score is divided into three systems, each with measures 6, 11, and 11. The Primo part starts with a *mf* dynamic and a *ritard* marking, followed by a *p* dynamic and a *a tempo* marking. The Secondo part also starts with a *mf* dynamic and a *ritard* marking, followed by a *p* dynamic and a *a tempo* marking. The first system ends with a *cresc.* marking. The second system starts with a *molto riten.* marking, followed by a *a tempo* marking. The third system starts with a *p* dynamic, followed by a *mp* dynamic, then a *mf* dynamic, and finally a *p* dynamic. The Primo part ends with a *mp espressivo* marking. The Secondo part ends with a *p* dynamic and a *leggero* marking.

Primo

Secondo

132

ritard

a tempo

mf

p

132

ritard

a tempo

mf

p

6

cresc.

molto riten.

a tempo

mp

6

cresc.

molto riten.

a tempo

mp

11

p

pp

mp

mf

p

mp espressivo

11

pp

p

mp

mf

p

leggero

4. The Python

Narrator: The python has, and I fib no fibs,
318 pairs of ribs.
In stating this I place reliance
On a seance with one who died for science.
This figure is sworn to and attested;
He counted them while being digested.

The musical score is for a piano piece titled "The Python" from the "Dies Irae" suite. It is written for two pianos, Primo and Secondo, in a key of three flats (B-flat major or D-flat minor) and common time (C). The tempo is marked as 90 beats per minute. The score consists of two systems of music. The first system has three measures. The second system has four measures, with the first measure marked with a box containing the number 4. The music features a variety of dynamics including *pp* (pianissimo), *p* (piano), *mp* (mezzo-piano), *mf* (mezzo-forte), *f* (forte), and *pp subito*. There are also markings for *quasi gliss.* and *subito*. The Primo part often plays a melodic line with grace notes, while the Secondo part provides a harmonic accompaniment with chords and moving lines. The time signature changes from common time to 2/4 in the second system.

5. The Fly

God in His wisdom made the fly And then forgot to tell us why.

Narrator 2/4 $\text{♩} = 84$ *sempre portamento e legato*

take Kazoo * mp mf

Narrator 2/4 $\text{♩} = 84$ *sempre portamento e legato*

take Kazoo * mp mf

Piano 2/4 $\text{♩} = 84$ mp mf

Piano 2/4 $\text{♩} = 84$

* One of the kazoo parts is put in a higher range than the other. The two parts may be exchanged between the narrator and one of the two pianists, depending on the vocal range of each. If necessary, some octave placements can be changed within each part as well to suit the comfort of each kazoo player.

** The piano part in this movement may be played by either the Primo or the Secondo pianist. The choice of who gets to play the kazoo in this piece is up to the performers, of course!

8 $\text{♩} = 132$

f f

8 $\text{♩} = 132$ mp

15

15

for Vincent Youmans and Harry Carroll

7. The Shrimp

Narrator **C** $\text{♩} = 84$ A shrimp who sought his lady shrimp Could catch no glimpse,

Primo **C** $\text{♩} = 84$ *p*

Secondo **C** *p*

Not even a glimpse. At times, translucence Is rather

a nuisance. **Allegro** $\text{♩} = 132$ *f*

Allegro $\text{♩} = 132$ *f*

The musical score is written for a Narrator and a piano duo (Primo and Secondo). The key signature has two flats (B-flat major), and the time signature is common time (C). The tempo is marked as 84 beats per minute for the first section and 132 beats per minute for the second section. The lyrics are: "A shrimp who sought his lady shrimp Could catch no glimpse, Not even a glimpse. At times, translucence Is rather a nuisance." The piano accompaniment features a steady eighth-note pattern in the right hand and a more complex, syncopated pattern in the left hand. The second section, marked "Allegro" at 132 bpm, features a more active piano accompaniment with a strong rhythmic drive.